UNREAL PAST

Would rather, it's time, as if · el pasado que no es pasado

Nivel C1

En inglés, el **pasado** no siempre habla del pasado: también expresa lo **irreal**, lo **deseado** o lo **imaginado**.

1 ¿Qué es?

- Forma de pasado, significado **presente o futuro**
- I'd rather you **stayed**. (= que te quedes)
- Irreal en el pasado → **past perfect**

2 Would rather / sooner

+ infinitivo — mismo sujeto: I'd rather **walk**.

+ sujeto + pasado — otro sujeto: I'd rather you **drove**.

I'd rather you **didn't** smoke here.

3 It's time

- It's (**high / about**) time + sujeto + **pasado**
- It's high time we **left**. (Ya va siendo hora.)
- Neutro: It's time **to** leave.

4 As if / as though

- Irreal → pasado: He talks **as if** he **knew** it all.
- Probable → presente: It looks **as if** it's going to rain.
- Antes → past perfect: as if he **had seen** a ghost

5 Suppose / imagine

- **Suppose / Imagine / What if** + pasado = hipótesis
- **Suppose** you **lost** your job…
- Pasado: **What if** he **had seen** us?

7 Error común

✗ I'd rather you don't tell her.

✓ I'd rather you didn't tell her.

would rather + otro sujeto → **pasado**

6 Consejo rápido

- Formal: **were** con todas las personas
- Negativa: I'd rather you **didn't**…
- would rather + infinitivo **sin to**

Mini ejercicio

Completa con la forma correcta del verbo.
Complete with the correct form of the verb.

1. I'd rather you _____ (not / smoke) here.
2. It's high time we _____ (go) home.
3. He acts as if he _____ (own) the place.
4. Suppose you _____ (win) the lottery…
5. I'd rather you _____ (tell) me yesterday.

Explicación · Explanation

Lee cada recuadro despacio. Primero en español, luego en inglés. Read each box slowly: first in Spanish, then in English.

¿Qué es? · What is it?

En inglés, el pasado tiene un segundo trabajo: expresar **distancia de la realidad**. Tras estructuras como **would rather**, **it's time**, **as if** o **suppose**, un verbo en pasado (went, knew, didn't) habla del **presente o del futuro**, pero de forma irreal, deseada o hipotética. Es el equivalente de muchos **subjuntivos** del español: prefiero que te quedes → I'd rather you **stayed**. Para referirnos a algo irreal en el pasado, damos **un paso más atrás**: past perfect (had gone). (Wish e if only, de la misma familia, se trabajan en B2.)

The past tense can express distance from reality. After would rather, it's time, as if or suppose, a past form refers to the present or future in an unreal way. For the unreal past, we step back again: past perfect.

would rather / it's time / as if + pasado simple + = irreal ahora

would rather / as if / suppose + past perfect + = irreal antes

Truco del paso atrás · The step-back trick

Piensa en el pasado como una **distancia**: alejarse en el tiempo = alejarse de la realidad. Un paso atrás (**presente → pasado**) = irreal ahora. Dos pasos atrás (**presente → past perfect**) = irreal en el pasado. Y donde en español pondrías **subjuntivo** (prefiero que vengas, ya es hora de que te vayas, como si fuera), en estas estructuras el inglés pone **pasado**.

Past = distance from reality. One step back = unreal now; two steps back = unreal past. Where Spanish uses the subjunctive, English uses the past.

1 · Would rather / would sooner · Preferences

would rather (contracción **'d rather**) y su variante menos frecuente **would sooner** significan preferiría. Si el sujeto es **el mismo**, van con **infinitivo sin to**: I'd rather stay in. Si hablamos de lo que preferimos que haga **otra persona**, usamos **sujeto + pasado**, aunque hablemos del presente o del futuro: I'd rather you stayed in (prefiero que te quedes). Negativas: **I'd rather not** + infinitivo / **I'd rather you didn't** + infinitivo, una forma muy educada de pedir que alguien **no** haga algo.

would rather / would sooner + bare infinitive (same subject); + another subject + past simple (present or future meaning). Negatives: I'd rather not…, I'd rather you didn't…

Sujeto + would rather + infinitivo

Sujeto + would rather + otro sujeto + pasado

I'd rather work from home tomorrow, if that's all right.
→ Preferiría trabajar desde casa mañana, si no hay problema.

I'd rather you didn't mention this to anyone.
→ Preferiría que no se lo comentaras a nadie.

My parents would sooner I studied law than drama.
→ Mis padres preferirían que estudiara Derecho en vez de Arte Dramático.

Would you rather I came back later?
→ ¿Prefieres que vuelva más tarde?

Todas las formas de WOULD RATHER · All the would rather patterns

Estructura	Tiempo	Ejemplo	Traducción
would rather + infinitivo	ahora / futuro	I'd rather **walk**.	Prefiero ir andando.
would rather not + infinitivo	ahora / futuro	I'd rather **not** say.	Prefiero no decirlo.
would rather + A + than + B	ahora / futuro	I'd rather **walk than** wait for the bus.	Prefiero andar que esperar el autobús.
would rather + sujeto + pasado	ahora / futuro	I'd rather you **drove**.	Prefiero que conduzcas tú.
would rather + sujeto + didn't	ahora / futuro	I'd rather you **didn't** smoke.	Preferiría que no fumaras.
would rather + sujeto + past perfect	pasado	I'd rather you **hadn't** come.	Habría preferido que no vinieras.
would rather have + participio	pasado	I'd rather **have flown**.	Habría preferido ir en avión.

would sooner sigue exactamente los mismos patrones. Respuesta corta muy útil: Shall I tell him? — I'd rather you didn't.

would sooner follows the same patterns. Useful reply: I'd rather you didn't.

WOULD RATHER, WOULD PREFER o PREFER · would rather, would prefer or prefer?

Las tres expresan preferencia, pero cada una tiene su propia gramática. ¡Ojo con el **to** y con **than / to**!

All three express preference, but each has its own grammar.

🙏 would rather

- + infinitivo **sin to**: I'd rather **go**.
- + sujeto + **pasado**: I'd rather you **went**.
- A **than** B: I'd rather go **than** stay.

🤝 would prefer

- + **to** + infinitivo: I'd prefer **to go**.
- + **it if** + pasado: I'd prefer **it if** you **went**.
- + objeto + to: I'd prefer you **to go**.

💚 prefer (en general)

- + -ing o nombre: I prefer **walking**.
- A **to** B: I prefer tea **to** coffee.
- Gustos generales, no una situación concreta.

2 · Preferencias sobre el pasado · Preferences about the past

Para expresar una preferencia sobre algo que **ya ocurrió**, damos un paso atrás: **would rather + otro sujeto + past perfect** (I'd rather you **had told** me = habría preferido que me lo dijeras). Si el sujeto es el mismo, usamos **would rather have + participio**: I'd rather **have stayed** at home (habría preferido quedarme en casa). En ambos casos, lo que pasó en realidad fue **lo contrario**.

Preferences about the past: would rather + subject + past perfect, or would rather have + past participle (same subject). What actually happened was the opposite.

would rather + otro sujeto + past perfect

would rather have + participio

🤨 I'd rather you had asked me before inviting them.
→ Habría preferido que me preguntaras antes de invitarlos.

📸 She'd rather they hadn't published the photos.
→ Ella habría preferido que no publicaran las fotos.

🏖️ To be honest, I'd rather have gone to the beach.
→ Sinceramente, habría preferido ir a la playa.

3 · It's time / high time / about time · It's time + past

It's time + sujeto + pasado significa ya es hora de que…: algo **debería estar pasando ya** y no pasa. Con **high** o **about** añadimos impaciencia, crítica o ironía (ya va siendo hora). Si no hay crítica y solo constatamos que ha llegado el momento, usamos **it's time (for + persona) + to + infinitivo**. Ojo: tras it's (high) time + sujeto no se usa ni el presente ni el past perfect.

It's (high / about) time + subject + past simple: something should already be happening (often critical). Neutral: It's time (for sb) to + infinitive.

It's (high / about) time + sujeto + pasado

It's time + (for + persona) + to + infinitivo

🏠 It's high time the government tackled the housing crisis.
→ Ya va siendo hora de que el Gobierno aborde la crisis de la vivienda.

💼 It's about time you found a proper job!
→ ¡Ya es hora de que te busques un trabajo como Dios manda!

🌙 It's time we were going — it's nearly midnight.
→ Ya es hora de que nos vayamos: es casi medianoche.

🛏️ It's time for the children to go to bed.
→ Es hora de que los niños se vayan a la cama.

4 · As if / as though · Unreal comparisons

🇪🇸 **as if** y **as though** (como si) son intercambiables. Tras ellos, el **pasado** indica que la comparación es **irreal o improbable**: He talks as if he **knew** everything (no lo sabe todo). Si la comparación es **probable o real**, usamos el tiempo normal: It looks as if it**'s going to** rain. Para algo irreal anterior: **past perfect** (as if he **had seen** a ghost). En registro formal se prefiere **were** con todas las personas; en lenguaje coloquial muchos nativos usan **like**. Expresiones: **It's not as if** + pasado = ¡ni que…!; **As if!** = ¡ni de broma!

🇬🇧 as if / as though + past = unreal comparison; + present = likely. Past perfect for an earlier unreal situation. Formal: were. It's not as if… = ¡ni que…!

verbo + as if / as though + pasado + (irreal)

verbo + as if + past perfect + (irreal y anterior)

He behaves **as if** he **owned** the company.
→ Se comporta como si fuera el dueño de la empresa.

She looked **as though** she **had seen** a ghost.
→ Tenía cara de haber visto un fantasma.

Don't talk to me **as if** I **were** a child.
→ No me hables como si fuera un niño.

It sounds **as if** the meeting **is going** well.
→ Parece que la reunión va bien.

5 · Suppose / imagine / what if · Imagining situations

🇪🇸 **Suppose**, **Supposing**, **Imagine** y **What if** (imagina que…, ¿y si…?) introducen hipótesis. Con **pasado**, la situación es **improbable o imaginaria** (presente o futuro); con **past perfect**, imaginamos un pasado distinto; con **presente**, la posibilidad es real. La oración principal suele llevar **would** (o **would have** para el pasado). (Supposing como alternativa a if se amplía en las condicionales avanzadas.)

🇬🇧 Suppose / Supposing / Imagine / What if + past = unlikely or imaginary; + past perfect = imagined past; + present = real possibility.

Suppose / Imagine / What if + pasado + … would …?

What if + past perfect + … would have …?

Suppose you **were** offered a job in Tokyo — would you take it?
→ Imagina que te ofrecieran un trabajo en Tokio: ¿lo aceptarías?

Imagine we **didn't have** the internet. How would we work?
→ Imagina que no tuviéramos internet. ¿Cómo trabajaríamos?

What if someone **had seen** us?
→ ¿Y si alguien nos hubiera visto?

Suppose it **rains** tomorrow — have we got a plan B?
→ Pongamos que mañana llueve: ¿tenemos un plan B?

UNREAL PAST

Would rather, it's time, as if · el pasado que no es pasado

📖 Explicación · Explanation | Nivel C1

AS IF + presente o + pasado · Likely or unreal?

El tiempo verbal revela lo que piensa el hablante: ¿es **posible o cierto**, o es **imaginario**?

The tense shows whether the speaker thinks it is likely or imaginary.

✅ Probable → presente

- You look **as if** you **need** a rest. (Probablemente sí.)
- It feels **as though** spring **has** finally **arrived**.

Irreal → pasado

- He spends **as if** he **were** a millionaire. (No lo es.)
- She treats me **as though** I **didn't exist**.

Resumen del unreal past · Unreal past at a glance

Estructura	Irreal ahora / futuro	Irreal en el pasado	Alternativa «real» o neutra
would rather / would sooner	I'd rather you **left**.	I'd rather you **had left**.	I'd rather **leave**. (mismo sujeto)
it's (high / about) time	It's time we **left**.	— (no se usa)	It's time **to leave**.
as if / as though	as if he **knew**	as if he **had known**	as if it's true (probable)
suppose / imagine / what if	Suppose you **lost** it…	What if you **had lost** it?	Suppose you **lose** it… (posible)
I'd prefer it if	I'd prefer it if you **stayed**.	I'd have preferred it if you **had stayed**.	I'd prefer **to stay**.
wish / if only (B2)	I wish I **knew**.	I wish I **had known**.	I hope I **know**.

Regla de oro: **pasado = irreal en el presente; past perfect = irreal en el pasado.** Con el verbo **be**, el registro formal prefiere **were**: as if I were…, suppose he were…; was es coloquial.

Golden rule: past = unreal now; past perfect = unreal past. Formal English prefers were.

Más ejemplos en contexto · More examples in context

- I'd rather we discussed this in private.
  → Preferiría que habláramos de esto en privado.
- Would you rather I didn't come to the meeting?
  → ¿Preferirías que no fuera a la reunión?
- I'd sooner resign than sign that document.
  → Antes dimitiría que firmar ese documento.
- It's high time we updated our privacy policy.
  → Ya va siendo hora de que actualicemos nuestra política de privacidad.
- Isn't it about time you apologised to her?
  → ¿No crees que ya va siendo hora de que le pidas perdón?
- He spoke as if nothing had happened.
  → Habló como si no hubiera pasado nada.
- She treats her assistant as though he were her servant.
  → Trata a su asistente como si fuera su criado.
- It looks as if we're going to miss the deadline.
  → Parece que vamos a incumplir el plazo.
- Supposing the bank refused the loan — what would we do?
  → Supongamos que el banco nos denegara el préstamo: ¿qué haríamos?
- Imagine you could live anywhere in the world.
  → Imagina que pudieras vivir en cualquier parte del mundo.
- What if the experiment had failed?
  → ¿Y si el experimento hubiera fracasado?
- I'd prefer it if you didn't use your phone during meals.
  → Preferiría que no usaras el móvil durante las comidas.
- It's not as if we were short of money.
  → Ni que estuviéramos mal de dinero.

¡Caza al monstruo! · Hunt the monster

Monstruo del error

✗ ~~I'd rather you don't tell her.~~
✓ I'd rather you didn't tell her.
would rather + otro sujeto → pasado, aunque hable del futuro. / would rather + another subject → past.

✗ ~~I'd rather to stay at home.~~
✓ I'd rather stay at home.
would rather + infinitivo sin to (would prefer sí lleva to). / No to after would rather.

✗ ~~It's time we go.~~
✓ It's time we went.
It's time + sujeto → pasado. / It's time + subject → past.

✗ ~~It's high time you had started studying.~~
✓ It's high time you started studying.
Tras it's time no se usa past perfect. / No past perfect after it's time.

✗ ~~She looked as if she has seen a ghost.~~
✓ She looked as if she had seen a ghost.
Irreal y anterior al momento pasado → past perfect. / Earlier unreal situation → past perfect.

✗ ~~Suppose you would win the lottery, what would you do?~~
✓ Suppose you won the lottery, what would you do?
Tras suppose / imagine → pasado, no would. / No would after suppose.

✗ ~~I'd rather walk that take a taxi.~~
✓ I'd rather walk than take a taxi.
Comparación → than (calco de «que»). / Comparison → than.

✗ ~~It's time for you go to bed.~~
✓ It's time for you to go to bed.
it's time for + persona + to + infinitivo. / it's time for sb to do.

UNREAL PAST

Would rather, it's time, as if · el pasado que no es pasado

📖 Explicación · Explanation | Nivel C1

¿Cómo construyo la frase? · How do I build it?

1. Identifica la estructura: **would rather, it's time, as if, suppose…**
   Identify the structure.
2. Con would rather, ¿es el **mismo sujeto**? → infinitivo sin to. ¿**Otro sujeto**? → sujeto + pasado.
   Same subject → bare infinitive; another subject → past.
3. ¿Es irreal en el **presente o futuro**? → **pasado simple** (were, didn't, went).
   Unreal now or in the future → past simple.
4. ¿Es irreal en el **pasado**? → **past perfect** (had gone), excepto con it's time.
   Unreal past → past perfect (not after it's time).
5. ¿Es **probable o real** (as if, suppose)? → tiempo normal (presente).
   Likely or real → normal tense.
6. Revisa el registro: **were** (formal) frente a **was** (coloquial).
   Check register: were (formal) vs was (informal).

Cambios en la oficina · Office reshuffle

Mark Have you heard? Management want us to move to an open-plan office.
¿Te has enterado? La dirección quiere que nos traslademos a una oficina diáfana.

Elena Seriously? I'd rather they spent the money on new laptops.
¿En serio? Preferiría que se gastaran el dinero en portátiles nuevos.

Mark Me too. And Harris talks about it as if it were a done deal.
Yo también. Y Harris habla de ello como si ya estuviera decidido.

Elena Well, it's high time somebody asked us what we think.
Pues ya va siendo hora de que alguien nos pregunte qué opinamos.

Cambios en la oficina · Office reshuffle (continúa · cont.)

Mark Suppose we wrote a joint letter — would people sign it?
Imagina que escribiéramos una carta conjunta: ¿la firmaría la gente?

Elena I think so. But I'd rather you didn't put my name at the top!
Creo que sí. ¡Pero preferiría que no pusieras mi nombre el primero!

Mark Fair enough. Mind you, I'd rather they had consulted us from the start.
Me parece justo. Eso sí, habría preferido que nos consultaran desde el principio.

Elena Exactly. It's not as if we didn't have any ideas!
Exacto. ¡Ni que no tuviéramos ideas!

Ejercicios · Practice

Escribe con lápiz y letra clara. Antes de escribir, piensa qué regla toca. Write in pencil. Think about the rule first.

Name · Nombre _____ Date · Fecha _____ Score _____

Ejercicio 1 Elige la forma correcta · Choose the correct form

Rodea la opción correcta.
Circle the correct option.

1. I'd rather you (didn't / don't) tell anyone about this.
2. It's high time the council (repaired / repairs) this road.
3. I'd rather (stay / to stay) in tonight, if you don't mind.
4. I'd prefer (to stay / stay) in tonight.
5. He looked as though he (hadn't slept / didn't sleep) for days.
6. Suppose you (lost / would lose) your passport abroad — what would you do?
7. The sky's grey. It looks as if it (is going to / were going to) snow.
8. I'd rather you (had warned / warned) me yesterday.
9. It's time (for us to leave / for us leaving).
10. I'd sooner walk (than / that) wait for a taxi.

Ejercicio 2 Une las dos mitades · Match the halves

Une el principio de cada frase con su final.
Match the beginning of each sentence with its ending.

1 I'd rather you didn't	a you called before visiting.
2 It's high time you	b were an expert on everything.
3 He talks as if he	c got your car serviced.
4 She looked as though she	d smoke in the car.
5 I'd rather have	e to make a decision.
6 I'd sooner resign	f than accept these conditions.
7 It's time for the board	g gone by train.
8 I'd prefer it if	h had been crying.

UNREAL PAST

Would rather, it's time, as if · el pasado que no es pasado

Ejercicios · Practice | Nivel C1

Ejercicio 3 ¿Ahora o antes? · Now or before?

¿La frase habla de una situación irreal en el presente/futuro o en el pasado? Clasifícalas.

Is the unreal situation in the present/future or in the past?

Word bank

- as though nobody had noticed
- I'd rather you had gone.
- It's time we left.
- I'd rather you didn't.
- What if they found out?
- Suppose she said no...
- I'd rather you went.
- as if he knew
- as if he had known
- What if she had said no?
- I'd rather have stayed.
- Imagine we had missed it!

Irreal ahora / futuro	Irreal en el pasado

Ejercicio 4 Pon el verbo en su forma · Put the verb in the right form

Escribe el verbo entre paréntesis en la forma correcta.

Write the verb in brackets in the correct form.

1. I'd rather you _____ (not / wear) jeans to the interview.
2. It's about time the trains _____ (run) on time.
3. He talks as if he _____ (be) the boss.
4. She looked as though she _____ (win) the lottery.

Ejercicio 4 Pon el verbo en su forma · Put the verb in the right form (continúa · cont.)

5. Suppose we _____ (miss) the last train — where would we sleep?
6. I'd rather you _____ (tell) me the truth from the start.
7. I'd rather _____ (not / discuss) it over the phone.
8. It's high time you _____ (start) taking your health seriously.
9. What if the alarm _____ (not / go) off? We'd have been robbed.
10. I'd rather _____ (take) the train; flying was a nightmare.

Ejercicio 5 Elige la expresión · Choose the expression

Completa con una expresión del recuadro. Puedes usar alguna más de una vez.

Complete with an expression from the box.

Word bank

- would rather
- would prefer
- suppose
- as if / as though
- it's high time
- it's time for

1. I _____ you didn't call me at work.
2. I _____ to discuss this face to face.
3. _____ we sold the flat — where would we live?
4. You look _____ you've just run a marathon.
5. _____ the company invested in training.

Ejercicio 5 Elige la expresión · Choose the expression
(continúa · cont.)

6 _____ the children to go to bed.

7 I _____ it if you didn't bring your dog.

8 He's acting _____ nothing had happened.

Ejercicio 6 Completa la tabla · Complete the table

✍️ Completa con la forma que pide cada columna después de I'd rather you...
Complete with the form each column needs after I'd rather you...

Verbo	Irreal ahora · I'd rather you...	Irreal pasado · I'd rather you...	Negativa ahora · I'd rather you...
go	went	_____	_____
tell	_____	had told	_____
be	_____	_____	weren't / wasn't
come	_____	_____	didn't come
leave	left	_____	_____
buy	_____	had bought	_____

Ejercicio 7 Ordena la frase · Put the words in order

Ordena las fichas y escribe la frase completa.
Put the words in order and write the sentence.

1. rather | you | I'd | didn't | smoke | here
2. time | we | high | it's | left
3. as if | he | talks | he | everything | knew
4. suppose | you | lost | your job | what | would | you | do | ?
5. had | she | as though | looked | she | a ghost | seen
6. rather | have | I'd | stayed | at home
7. about | you | it's | time | apologised
8. sooner | I'd | resign | than | lie | to the board

Ejercicio 8 ¿Qué significa? · What does it mean?

Lee la frase y decide si la afirmación es verdadera (T) o falsa (F).
Read the sentence and decide if the statement is true or false.

1. "I'd rather you didn't come." → The speaker wants the listener to come. T F
2. "It's high time we left." → We should already be leaving. T F
3. "He talks as if he were a doctor." → He is a doctor. T F
4. "It looks as if it's going to rain." → Rain is likely. T F
5. "I'd rather you had told me." → You told me. T F
6. "Suppose you won the lottery." → The speaker thinks winning is quite likely. T F
7. "I'd rather have stayed at home." → I didn't stay at home. T F
8. "It's not as if we were short of money." → We have enough money. T F

Ejercicio 9 — Reformula con la estructura · Rewrite with the structure given

✍️ Reescribe la frase con la estructura entre paréntesis, sin cambiar el significado.
🇬🇧 Rewrite the sentence using the structure in brackets.

1. Please don't park here. **(I'd rather)**
2. You should start looking for a flat now. **(It's high time)**
3. He isn't rich, but he spends money like a rich man. **(as if)**
4. I'm sorry you didn't tell me earlier. **(I'd rather)**
5. Imagine this: you meet the Prime Minister. What do you say? **(Suppose)**
6. I'd prefer to walk. **(I'd rather)**
7. I'd prefer you not to come tomorrow. **(I'd prefer it if)**
8. I regret going by bus; the train would have been better. **(I'd rather have)**

Ejercicio 10 — Transformaciones clave · Key word transformations (C1 Advanced)

✍️ Completa la segunda frase para que signifique lo mismo que la primera. Usa la palabra clave sin cambiarla y entre 3 y 6 palabras.
🇬🇧 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the key word and 3–6 words.

1. I'd prefer you not to tell Sam about this.
   I'd _____ Sam about this. (RATHER)
2. You should have applied for a passport long ago.
   It's _____ for a passport. (HIGH)
3. It's a shame you didn't ask my permission first.
   I'd _____ my permission first. (RATHER)
4. He behaves like the owner of the company, but he isn't.
   He behaves _____ the company. (OWNED)
5. What would you do if you were stranded on a desert island?
   _____ stranded on a desert island — what would you do? (SUPPOSE)

Ejercicio 10 Transformaciones clave · Key word transformations (C1 Advanced) (continúa · cont.)

6 I would prefer to travel by train rather than fly.
I'd _____ fly. (SOONER)

7 From her face, I think she has had some bad news.
She looks _____ some bad news. (THOUGH)

8 We really ought to change our supplier now.
It's _____ our supplier. (ABOUT)

Ejercicio 11 Caza el error · Find the mistake

Cada frase tiene UN error. Escríbela correctamente.
Each sentence has ONE mistake. Write it correctly.

1 ✗ I'd rather you don't call me after ten.
✓

2 ✗ It's time we start the meeting.
✓

3 ✗ I'd rather to pay by card.
✓

Ejercicio 11 Caza el error · Find the mistake (continúa · cont.)

4 ✗ She talked as though she has known him for years.
✓

5 ✗ Suppose you would lose your keys — who would you call?
✓

6 ✗ It's high time for you finding a job.
✓

7 ✗ I'd rather go by train that by bus.
✓

8 ✗ I'd rather you would stay.
✓

Ejercicio 12 Lee y contesta · Read and answer

✍️ Lee la carta y la respuesta del consultorio. Marca T (verdadero) o F (falso) y contesta las preguntas.
Read the letter and the advice column reply. Tick T or F and answer the questions.

Ask Amanda: "My colleague acts as if he were my boss"

Dear Amanda, I've worked in the same team as Greg for three years. Although we have the same job title, he behaves as if he were in charge of the whole department. He hands out tasks, comments on my emails and talks to me as though I had joined the company yesterday. I'd rather he didn't involve himself in my work, but I don't want to cause a scene. Suppose I complained to our manager — would that make things worse? — Fed up in Bristol

Dear Fed up, it's high time you stood up for yourself. Greg probably doesn't realise how he comes across, so I'd rather you spoke to him before going to your manager. Imagine you were in his position: wouldn't you prefer a quiet word to a formal complaint? Choose a calm moment and say something like: "I'd prefer it if you let me manage my own emails." If nothing changes, then it will be time to involve your manager. And remember: it's not as if you were asking for anything unreasonable.

1 Greg is the writer's boss. T F

2 The writer wants to cause a scene. T F

3 How does Greg talk to the writer?

4 What would the writer rather Greg didn't do?

Ejercicio 12 Lee y contesta · Read and answer (continúa · cont.)

5 Amanda advises going straight to the manager. T F

6 What sentence does Amanda suggest saying to Greg?

7 Find an example of it's high time + past in the reply.

8 What does Amanda mean by "it's not as if you were asking for anything unreasonable"?

Ejercicio 13 Traduce al inglés · Translate into English

✍️ Traduce. ¡Recuerda: donde el español usa subjuntivo, aquí el inglés usa pasado!
Translate into English.

1 Preferiría que no me llamaras al trabajo.

2 Ya va siendo hora de que arreglen esta carretera.

3 (Él) habla como si lo supiera todo.

4 Imagina que te ofrecieran el puesto: ¿lo aceptarías?

Ejercicio 13 Traduce al inglés · Translate into English

(continúa · cont.)

5 Habría preferido que me lo dijeras antes.

6 Prefiero no hablar de ello.

7 ¡Ni que fuera millonario! (yo)

8 ¿Y si nos hubieran visto?

9 Es hora de que los niños se vayan a la cama.

Ejercicio 14 Ahora escribe tú · Your turn

Escribe frases sobre tu vida con las estructuras de este mapa.
Write about your life using the structures in this map.

1 Escribe dos cosas que preferirías que hicieran (o no hicieran) tus compañeros de trabajo o de piso. (I'd rather you / they…)

2 Escribe dos cosas que **ya va siendo hora** de que cambien en tu ciudad. (It's high time…)

3 Describe a alguien que se comporta **como si…** (as if / as though)

4 Plantea una hipótesis y contéstala. (Suppose / Imagine / What if…)

¿Lo he aprendido? · Can I do it?

Marca cada frase cuando la sepas hacer y colorea las estrellas. Tick each line when you can do it and colour the stars.

Lo sé hacer · I can...

- [ ] Uso **would rather / would sooner** + infinitivo o + sujeto + pasado. ☆☆☆
  I can use would rather / would sooner correctly.
- [ ] Expreso preferencias sobre el pasado con **past perfect** o **would rather have**. ☆☆☆
  I can express preferences about the past.
- [ ] Distingo **would rather** (sin to), **would prefer** (to) y **prefer**. ☆☆☆
  I can distinguish would rather, would prefer and prefer.
- [ ] Uso **it's (high / about) time** + pasado y **it's time to...** ☆☆☆
  I can use it's (high) time + past and it's time to...
- [ ] Elijo presente o pasado tras **as if / as though** según sea real o irreal. ☆☆☆
  I can choose the right tense after as if / as though.
- [ ] Planteo hipótesis con **suppose, imagine, what if**. ☆☆☆
  I can imagine situations with suppose, imagine, what if.

Mi progreso · My progress

Colorea 1, 2 o 3 estrellas en cada ejercicio. Colour 1, 2 or 3 stars for each exercise.

Ej. 1 ☆☆☆	Ej. 2 ☆☆☆	Ej. 3 ☆☆☆	Ej. 4 ☆☆☆
Ej. 5 ☆☆☆	Ej. 6 ☆☆☆	Ej. 7 ☆☆☆	Ej. 8 ☆☆☆
Ej. 9 ☆☆☆	Ej. 10 ☆☆☆	Ej. 11 ☆☆☆	Ej. 12 ☆☆☆
Ej. 13 ☆☆☆	Ej. 14 ☆☆☆		

Solucionario · Answer key

Para el adulto que corrige (¡o para comprobar después de hacerlo!). For the grown-up who checks, or to check after you finish.

Mapa · Mini ejercicio

1. didn't smoke · 2. went · 3. owned · 4. won · 5. had told

Ejercicio 1 · Elige la forma correcta

1. didn't · 2. repaired · 3. stay · 4. to stay · 5. hadn't slept · 6. lost · 7. is going to · 8. had warned · 9. for us to leave · 10. than

Ejercicio 2 · Une las dos mitades

1-d · 2-c · 3-b · 4-h · 5-g · 6-f · 7-e · 8-a

Ejercicio 3 · ¿Ahora o antes?

Irreal ahora / futuro: I'd rather you went., It's time we left., as if he knew, Suppose she said no..., I'd rather you didn't., What if they found out?
Irreal en el pasado: I'd rather you had gone., as if he had known, What if she had said no?, I'd rather have stayed., as though nobody had noticed, Imagine we had missed it!

Ejercicio 4 · Pon el verbo en su forma

1. didn't wear · 2. ran · 3. were / was · 4. had won · 5. missed · 6. had told · 7. not discuss · 8. started · 9. hadn't gone · 10. have taken

Ejercicio 5 · Elige la expresión

1. would rather · 2. would prefer · 3. Suppose · 4. as if / as though · 5. It's high time · 6. It's time for · 7. would prefer · 8. as if / as though

Ejercicio 6 · Completa la tabla

Verbo	Irreal ahora · I'd rather you...	Irreal pasado · I'd rather you...	Negativa ahora · I'd rather you...
go	went	had gone	didn't go
tell	told	had told	didn't tell
be	were / was	had been	weren't / wasn't
come	came	had come	didn't come
leave	left	had left	didn't leave
buy	bought	had bought	didn't buy

Ejercicio 7 · Ordena la frase

1. I'd rather you didn't smoke here.
2. It's high time we left.
3. He talks as if he knew everything.
4. Suppose you lost your job, what would you do?
5. She looked as though she had seen a ghost.
6. I'd rather have stayed at home.
7. It's about time you apologised.
8. I'd sooner resign than lie to the board.

Ejercicio 8 · ¿Qué significa?

1. False ✗ — Prefiere que no venga.
2. True ✓ — Implica que ya vamos tarde.
3. False ✗ — Pasado tras as if = irreal.
4. True ✓ — Presente tras as if = probable.
5. False ✗ — Past perfect = no me lo dijiste.

Ejercicio 8 · ¿Qué significa? (continúa · cont.)

6. False ✗ — Pasado = hipótesis improbable.
7. True ✓ — Preferencia sobre el pasado: pasó lo contrario.
8. True ✓ — It's not as if… = ¡ni que…!

Ejercicio 9 · Reformula con la estructura

1. I'd rather you didn't park here.
2. It's high time you started looking for a flat.
3. He spends money as if he were rich. / He spends money as if he was rich.
4. I'd rather you had told me earlier.
5. Suppose you met the Prime Minister — what would you say?
6. I'd rather walk.
7. I'd prefer it if you didn't come tomorrow.
8. I'd rather have gone by train.

Ejercicio 10 · Transformaciones clave

1. rather you didn't tell / rather you did not tell
2. high time you applied
3. rather you had asked (for)
4. as if he owned / as though he owned
5. Suppose you were
6. sooner travel by train than
7. as though she has had / as though she's had
8. about time we changed

Ejercicio 11 · Caza el error

1. I'd rather you didn't call me after ten.
2. It's time we started the meeting.
3. I'd rather pay by card.
4. She talked as though she had known him for years.

Ejercicio 11 · Caza el error (continúa · cont.)

5. Suppose you lost your keys — who would you call?
6. It's high time you found a job. / It's high time for you to find a job.
7. I'd rather go by train than by bus.
8. I'd rather you stayed.

Ejercicio 12 · Lee y contesta

1. False ✗ — They have the same job title; he only behaves as if he were the boss.
2. False ✗ — "I don't want to cause a scene."
3. As though the writer had joined the company yesterday.
4. Involve himself in the writer's work.
5. False ✗ — She'd rather the writer spoke to Greg first.
6. "I'd prefer it if you let me manage my own emails."
7. "It's high time you stood up for yourself."
8. That the writer's request is perfectly reasonable.

Ejercicio 13 · Traduce al inglés

1. I'd rather you didn't call me at work.
2. It's high time they repaired this road. / It's high time they fixed this road.
3. He talks as if he knew everything. / He talks as though he knew everything.
4. Suppose you were offered the job — would you accept it? / Imagine they offered you the job — would you accept it?
5. I'd rather you had told me earlier.
6. I'd rather not talk about it.
7. It's not as if I were a millionaire! / It's not as if I was a millionaire!
8. What if they had seen us?
9. It's time for the children to go to bed. / It's time the children went to bed.

Ejercicio 14 · Ahora escribe tú

1. Ej.: I'd rather my flatmates didn't leave dishes in the sink. I'd rather people turned off their phones in meetings.
2. Ej.: It's high time the council built more cycle lanes. It's about time rents came down.
3. Ej.: My neighbour drives as if he were in a Formula 1 race.
4. Ej.: Suppose I won a scholarship to study abroad — I would go to Canada.